

Animation Demo in App Inventor 2

With the development of Android apps being all the rage, we move a step further in our quest to master App Inventor 2. In this article, the author touches upon the basics of using animation in Android apps.



So far, we have developed what might be called static purpose apps, wherein one particular task is associated with the application—whether it’s playing music, creating a note or counting things using a manual or automatic counter. However, a smartphone has much more to offer and is far ahead of the phones of the recent past. We are talking about animation and gaming here. Everyone is fascinated by the crystal clear graphics and character movements of what is termed as animation. In this tutorial, we will learn some basics of animation and how it can be incorporated in apps.

The theme of the application

Playing games on smartphones has become one of the favourite pastimes in our daily lives – something we engage in while travelling or during idle hours. Over the years, gaming on smartphones has been hyped so much that every age group, from little kids to elders of the family, is playing games, and with the collaboration offered by social media, the gaming fever has spread very rapidly. In this article, we will explore how games are made, what is the logic behind them, and

look at all the things that make a character move as per your instructions, all over the screen of your smartphone. Let’s create a simple animation using the App Inventor, which will allow you to control a ball on the screen with various controls.

In the last application we created, you got to know about the various options and features available on the designer or block editor in the App Inventor browser application. We will use the same tools here, along with a few other components.

GUI requirements

For every application, there is a graphical user interface or GUI, which helps the user to interact with the onscreen components. How each component responds to user actions is defined in the block editor section.

As per our requirements, we will need the following components.

1. **Canvas:** The Canvas component works as the base of the animation, and it provides the platform over which the object will move as per instructions.
2. **Label:** Labels are the static text components, which are